

KMVTECH EDUCATION**CEL1 · Module 6****Pollution and resources**

Lesson: Pollution, water, waste

Student Lesson Notes

Study with the online lessons. Prefer primary sources (Constitution, statutes, treaties, cases). © KMVTECH Education · September 2026.

1. CORE IDEA

Pollution control rests on standards (ambient and emission), licences, monitoring, enforcement and liability. Water resources are regulated through abstraction and discharge permits, catchment management and the protection of water sources.

Waste management follows hierarchy principles (reduce, reuse, recycle) and controls on hazardous and non-hazardous waste, including transboundary movements under Basel-aligned rules.

Air, noise and land contamination regimes complete the pollution picture. Climate mitigation and adaptation measures increasingly intersect with classical pollution law.

- Integrated permitting and cumulative-impact analysis are modern directions.

2. DETAILED RULES AND APPLICATION

Example: an industry discharging into a river needs both an effluent licence and compliance with water-quality standards; illegal dumping of hazardous waste engages criminal and civil liability.

Identify the medium (air, water, land, waste stream), the applicable standard or licence, and the enforcement or liability route.

3. UGANDA / PRACTICE, METHOD AND TRAPS

Uganda's water, waste and pollution regulations under the framework Act and sectoral laws provide the tools; enforcement capacity and data gaps limit effectiveness. Community monitoring and public-interest suits help fill gaps.

Exam trap: analysing only the end-of-pipe licence while ignoring ambient standards, cumulative impacts or the waste hierarchy.

Method: characterise the pollutant and pathway → locate standard and licence regime → check monitoring and reporting duties → map civil, administrative and criminal enforcement options.

Links forward to biodiversity (pollution as a driver of loss) and liability.

SELF-TEST QUESTIONS

Attempt these before the platform practice quiz.

1. What is the waste hierarchy?
2. Name two types of water-related permits.
3. What does an ambient standard protect?
4. How does the Basel Convention relate to domestic waste law?
5. Why do cumulative impacts matter?
6. What enforcement tools exist beyond licences?

Exam tip: Medium + standard/licence + enforcement route.

CHECKLIST BEFORE YOU LEAVE THIS LESSON

- I can state the main instrument(s) or Cap number.
- I can explain the core rule in my own words.
- I can apply the rule to a short Uganda / regional fact pattern.
- I know the common exam trap for this topic.
- I know how this lesson links to the next module.

Next step: Complete the online practice quiz for this lesson, then continue on the platform.